

■ DEFENSE COMMISSARY AGENCY ■

Supply Chain Operations Division | Logistics & Distribution Directorate

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SOP-01: Receiving & Inspection

Standard Operating Procedure — Supply Chain Operations

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1. Purpose

The purpose of this Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) is to establish uniform, repeatable, and auditable processes for the receiving and inspection of all inbound shipments at Defense Commissary Agency (DeCA) Distribution Centers (DCs). This SOP prescribes the mandatory steps, responsibilities, documentation requirements, and decision authorities governing the acceptance, conditional acceptance, or rejection of inbound freight from approved vendors and commercial carriers.

Specifically, this SOP is designed to:

- **Ensure product quality** by verifying that all inbound goods meet DeCA quality standards, applicable federal food safety regulations, and contractual specifications prior to placement into inventory;
- **Verify quantity accuracy** by confirming that all received quantities match approved Purchase Order (PO) line items, thereby preventing short-shipment losses and overage discrepancies;
- **Enforce food safety compliance** in accordance with U.S. Food and Drug Administration (FDA) Food Safety Modernization Act (FSMA) requirements, U.S. Department of Agriculture Food Safety and Inspection Service (USDA/FSIS) regulations, and applicable DeCA directives governing

temperature-controlled products, perishables, and meat/poultry/seafood products;

- **Support timely and accurate Warehouse Management System (WMS) entry** to maintain real-time inventory visibility, lot traceability, and FIFO (First-In First-Out) stock rotation across all DeCA DC locations;
- **Protect DeCA and the warfighter/commissary patron** from unsafe, mislabeled, damaged, or non-compliant products entering the supply chain; and
- **Establish a standardized non-conformance process** to document, report, and resolve vendor discrepancies in a timely manner consistent with DeCA Vendor Compliance requirements and federal acquisition regulations.

This SOP supports DeCA's overarching mission to deliver a benefit to the military community by operating efficient commissaries that provide quality grocery products at significant savings.

2. Scope

This SOP applies to **all DeCA Distribution Centers (DCs)** throughout the continental United States (CONUS) and Outside Continental United States (OCONUS) locations that receive inbound freight from approved DeCA vendors, commercial carriers, and government supply sources.

This procedure applies to and is binding upon the following personnel and organizational elements:

- **Dock Personnel** — All warehouse associates assigned to inbound receiving docks, including lead dock hands and dock operations technicians;
- **Quality Inspectors** — All individuals designated and credentialed to perform physical, thermal, and documentation inspection of inbound product at DeCA DCs;
- **Receiving Clerks** — All clerical and WMS-entry personnel responsible for processing receiving transactions, BOL documentation, and PO reconciliation;

- **DC Supervisors** — Supervisory personnel overseeing daily inbound operations, non-conformance decisions, and escalation actions;
- **Transportation Coordinators** — Personnel coordinating carrier scheduling, dock door assignment, and carrier communication;
- **Vendors and Authorized Carrier Drivers** — Commercial vendors and their contracted carriers delivering product under DeCA-approved Purchase Orders.

This SOP applies to all product categories received at DeCA DCs, including but not limited to: frozen foods, refrigerated meats and poultry, dairy products, fresh produce, dry/ambient grocery items, health and beauty care (HBC) products, and general merchandise.

NOTE

This SOP does not apply to direct-store delivery (DSD) shipments received at individual commissary locations. Separate procedures govern DSD operations. For inter-DC transfers, refer to DeCA-SC-SOP-07 (Inter-Facility Transfer Procedures).

3. References

The following documents, directives, and regulations are applicable to this SOP and shall be consulted in conjunction with this procedure. In the event of a conflict between this SOP and a higher-authority directive, the higher-authority document governs.

Reference ID	Title / Description	Authority
DeCA Directive 40-13	Commissary Operations — Establishes overarching operational policy for DeCA commissary and distribution operations, including inbound supply	Defense Commissary Agency

Reference ID	Title / Description	Authority
	chain requirements.	
USDA FSIS Regulations	Federal meat, poultry, and egg product inspection regulations; labeling requirements; and FSIS Directive 7000.1 series governing inspection of regulated products.	U.S. Dept. of Agriculture — Food Safety & Inspection Service
FDA FSMA (21 U.S.C. § 2201 et seq.)	FDA Food Safety Modernization Act — Establishes preventive controls, sanitary transportation, and traceability requirements for food supply chains.	U.S. Food & Drug Administration
DeCA Vendor Compliance Manual, Rev. 2026	Mandatory compliance standards for all DeCA-approved vendors, including labeling, packaging, delivery scheduling, temperature requirements, and chargeback policies.	Defense Commissary Agency
DoD 4140.01	DoD Supply Chain Materiel Management Policy — Governs materiel receipt, inspection, storage, and inventory accountability across DoD logistics operations.	U.S. Department of Defense
ISO 9001:2015	Quality Management Systems — Requirements. Provides the framework for documented quality processes, including incoming inspection and non-conformance management.	International Organization for Standardization
FAR 4.703	Federal Acquisition Regulation — Contractor Record Retention. Establishes minimum 3-year record retention requirements for federally contracted procurement activities.	General Services Administration / DoD
21 CFR Part 117	Current Good	U.S. Food & Drug

Reference ID	Title / Description	Authority
	Manufacturing Practice, Hazard Analysis, and Risk-Based Preventive Controls for Human Food.	Administration

4. Definitions

For the purposes of this SOP, the following terms and abbreviations are defined as follows:

Term / Abbreviation	Definition
Bill of Lading (BOL)	A legally binding shipping document issued by the carrier that identifies the shipper, consignee, origin, destination, and itemized description of goods being transported. The BOL serves as the primary document for quantity and shipment verification during the receiving process.
Purchase Order (PO)	A formal procurement document issued by DeCA authorizing the purchase of specific goods from an approved vendor at agreed-upon prices, quantities, and delivery conditions. All received shipments must be traceable to an active, open PO.
Warehouse Management System (WMS)	The enterprise software platform used by DeCA DCs to manage inbound receiving transactions, inventory locations, lot number tracking, FIFO rotation, and stock movement. All receiving events must be recorded in the WMS within the timeframe specified in this SOP.
Lot Number	A unique alphanumeric identifier assigned by the manufacturer to a specific production batch of a product, enabling traceability for recall, quality control, and regulatory compliance purposes. Example: LOT-TC-8812.
Expiration Date	The date stamped on a product or its packaging by the manufacturer beyond which the product is considered unfit for

Term / Abbreviation	Definition
	sale or consumption. DeCA policy requires a minimum of 50% remaining shelf life at the time of receipt for all dated items.
Temperature Excursion	An event in which a temperature-sensitive product has been exposed to temperatures outside its specified acceptable range during transit or storage, potentially compromising product safety or quality. Temperature excursions constitute grounds for rejection under this SOP.
Rejection Tag	DeCA Form 1140-R — A brightly colored physical tag affixed to non-conforming pallets, cases, or units to visually segregate and quarantine product that has been rejected during inspection and is pending disposition or vendor retrieval.
FIFO (First-In First-Out)	A stock rotation method requiring that products received earliest are stored and issued before products received later, minimizing the risk of product expiration and waste. All storage placement actions under this SOP must conform to FIFO.
Certificate of Analysis (COA)	A document issued by a manufacturer or certified third-party laboratory confirming that a specific production lot meets defined quality specifications. Certain regulated product categories (e.g., infant formula, dietary supplements, seafood) require a COA to accompany each delivery.
Non-Conformance Report (NCR)	A formal written record documenting a deviation from specified requirements identified during receiving inspection, including the nature of the discrepancy, affected items, disposition decision, and corrective action.
Reefer Unit	A refrigeration unit installed on a temperature-controlled trailer used to maintain specified temperature conditions during product transport.

5. Roles and Responsibilities

The following table defines the primary roles involved in the receiving and inspection process and delineates their respective responsibilities under this SOP. All personnel must complete required training prior to performing assigned functions (see Section 13).

Role	Primary Responsibilities	Authority Level
Receiving Clerk	Verify scheduled deliveries in WMS prior to truck arrival Match BOL to open PO number, vendor information, and item manifest Document quantity counts and discrepancies on BOL and receiving checklist (DeCA Form 1141-R) Enter all received quantities, lot numbers, and storage locations into WMS Submit vendor discrepancy notifications via the DeCA Vendor Portal within 24 hours Maintain and file all receiving documentation per Section 11	Operational — data entry and documentation
Quality Inspector	Conduct trailer temperature verification prior to door opening Perform physical inspection of all inbound product for damage, contamination, and packaging integrity Record internal product temperatures using calibrated probe and infrared thermometers Verify lot numbers, expiration dates, USDA/FSIS stamps, and COAs as required Make Accept, Accept-Partial, or Reject disposition recommendations Affix Rejection Tags (DeCA Form 1140-R) to all non-conforming items Initiate	Inspection authority — disposition recommendation

Role	Primary Responsibilities	Authority Level
	Non-Conformance Reports (NCR) for rejected shipments	
DC Supervisor	Oversee daily receiving and inspection operations and ensure SOP compliance Authorize final Accept, Accept-Partial, or Reject disposition for borderline cases Escalate vendor chargeback actions exceeding \$500 to the Contracting Officer Review and sign off on all NCRs within 2 business days of initiation Monitor KPI performance and report deviations to Logistics & Distribution Director Ensure all personnel are trained and certified per Section 13	Supervisory — final disposition authority and escalation
Transportation Coordinator	Manage inbound delivery schedule and confirm appointments in WMS Assign dock door numbers to scheduled deliveries Coordinate carrier communication for arrival, delays, and rejected load pickup Notify Quality Inspector of arriving temperature-controlled shipments at least 30 minutes prior to scheduled arrival Document carrier compliance or non-compliance with delivery window requirements	Coordination — scheduling and carrier interface
Vendor / Driver	Present valid BOL, product manifest, and required COAs upon arrival Provide reefer unit temperature printout (continuous temperature log) for	Compliance — delivery and documentation cooperation

Role	Primary Responsibilities	Authority Level
	refrigerated/frozen shipments Cooperate fully with quantity count, product inspection, and documentation requirements Segregate rejected product and remove from DC premises upon notification Acknowledge discrepancy documentation by signing BOL notation	
WMS Administrator	Maintain WMS user access, roles, and permissions for receiving personnel Ensure WMS PO data is current and aligned with active Contracting Office awards Generate receiving accuracy and discrepancy reports for KPI monitoring Provide technical support for WMS terminal issues during receiving operations Archive WMS receiving transaction logs per Section 11 retention requirements	Technical — system maintenance and reporting

6. Required Equipment and Forms

The following equipment, instruments, and forms are required to perform receiving and inspection operations under this SOP. All measurement instruments must be calibrated and within valid calibration cycle at all times. Equipment deficiencies must be reported to the DC Supervisor immediately.

Item	Description / Specification	Required For
Calibrated Probe Thermometer	NIST-certified, digital, with range of -40°F to +140°F,	Internal product temperature verification

Item	Description / Specification	Required For
	accuracy $\pm 1^{\circ}\text{F}$, calibrated semi-annually. Calibration tag must be affixed and current.	(Sections 7.2, 7.7)
Infrared (IR) Thermometer	Non-contact, laser-sighted, range -58°F to $+716^{\circ}\text{F}$. Used for initial surface temperature scanning of cases and pallets. NIST-calibrated annually.	Non-invasive surface temperature check (Section 7.2)
Pallet Jacks (Manual/Electric)	Standard 5,500 lb. capacity pallet jacks, inspected daily per powered industrial truck (PIT) checklist. Electric models must be fully charged.	Moving pallets from dock to inspection area and storage (Section 7.12)
Certified Floor Scales	Legal-for-trade scales, capacity 5,000 lb., calibrated quarterly. Used to verify catch-weight items and pallet weights where applicable.	Weight verification for catch-weight and random-weight items (Section 7.4)
Rejection Tags (DeCA Form 1140-R)	Pre-printed, brightly colored (red) hang tags with fields for date, PO number, lot number, reason for rejection, and inspector ID. Tamper-resistant.	Marking non-conforming product (Section 7.8, 7.11)
BOL Stamp	Official DeCA DC inbound receiving stamp including DC facility code, date/time, inspector initials, and received/partial received/rejected status fields.	Endorsing all inbound BOLs (Section 7.3)
WMS Terminal / Scanner	Handheld RF barcode scanner or fixed WMS workstation terminal connected to DeCA enterprise WMS. Must be functional and network-connected prior to receiving.	PO verification, lot scanning, and WMS entry (Sections 7.1, 7.6, 7.9)
Personal Protective	Includes: steel-toed boots	All dock and inspection

Item	Description / Specification	Required For
Equipment (PPE)	(ASTM F2413), high-visibility safety vest, safety glasses, food-safe nitrile gloves (for food product contact), and hard hat (in rack areas).	activities
Receiving Inspection Checklist (DeCA Form 1141-R)	Standardized paper and electronic form capturing: PO number, vendor, BOL number, product description, lot number, expiration date, temperature readings, quantity counts, inspection findings, and disposition decision. Must be completed for every inbound delivery.	Full inspection documentation (Sections 7.3–7.8)
Continuous Temperature Data Logger	Electronic data logger placed in trailer by carrier, providing a time-stamped temperature record for the entire transit duration. Reviewed by inspector upon arrival.	Transit temperature verification (Section 7.2)

7. Procedure

The following numbered steps constitute the mandatory sequence of actions for receiving and inspecting all inbound shipments at DeCA Distribution Centers. Personnel shall not skip, abbreviate, or reorder steps without written authorization from the DC Supervisor. All steps must be documented on DeCA Form 1141-R unless otherwise specified.

7.1 Pre-Arrival Preparation

PREPAREDNESS REQUIREMENT

Pre-arrival preparation must be completed no later than 30 minutes before the scheduled delivery window. Failure to complete pre-arrival preparation may result in dock delays and must be reported to the DC Supervisor.

1. **Verify Scheduled Delivery in WMS:** The Receiving Clerk shall log into the WMS and navigate to the Inbound Shipment Schedule module to confirm the delivery is scheduled, the associated PO number is open and active, and all expected line items and quantities are visible. *Example: Verify PO-2026-00441 for Tyson Foods Inc., scheduled for dock arrival 0800-1000 hrs. Confirm 48 cases of frozen chicken breast (Item #TF-7742) are listed in WMS under PO-2026-00441.*
2. **Retrieve and Review PO Documentation:** Print or display the full PO detail from WMS, including vendor name, vendor code, ship-from location, expected SKUs, case quantities, unit weights, and any special handling notes (e.g., temperature requirements, COA requirement flags).
3. **Assign Dock Door:** The Transportation Coordinator shall assign a dock door number in WMS based on delivery type (e.g., refrigerated product must be assigned to a dock equipped with dock seals/shelters and connected to the cold chain receiving area). Record the assigned dock door on DeCA Form 1141-R.
4. **Notify Quality Inspector:** The Transportation Coordinator shall notify the designated Quality Inspector (by name and Inspector ID) of the pending delivery at least 30 minutes prior to the scheduled arrival time. *Example: Notify Inspector INS-042 of the Tyson Foods delivery on Dock Door 7, ETA 0800 hrs. Inspector INS-042 must be on-site and equipped with calibrated thermometers and PPE prior to trailer arrival.*
5. **Stage Required Equipment and Forms:** The Quality Inspector shall confirm that all required equipment listed in Section 6 is available, functional, and within calibration. Retrieve a blank DeCA Form 1141-R for the pending delivery.

6. **Confirm Dock Readiness:** Verify that the assigned dock door is clear, dock leveler is functional, and dock seal/shelter is in place (for temperature-sensitive loads).

7.2 Vehicle Arrival and Temperature Verification

CRITICAL — DO NOT OPEN TRAILER DOORS BEFORE COMPLETING STEP 7.2

Opening trailer doors before recording trailer temperature violates cold-chain integrity protocols and invalidates the temperature record. This step is mandatory for all refrigerated and frozen shipments.

7. **Greet Driver and Check In:** The Receiving Clerk shall verify the driver's identity and carrier credentials, confirm the BOL number matches the scheduled delivery in WMS, and direct the driver to the assigned dock door.
8. **Check Reefer Unit Operation:** Before the trailer is backed into the dock, the Quality Inspector shall visually verify that the reefer unit is running, note the reefer unit set-point temperature displayed on the unit's control panel, and request the continuous temperature data logger printout from the driver.
9. **Record Trailer Ambient Temperature:** Using the calibrated IR thermometer, record the air temperature at the trailer door seal (without opening the door) on DeCA Form 1141-R. Log the date, time, dock door number, and Inspector ID.

Example: Inspector INS-042 records trailer ambient temperature of 32°F at 0807 hrs, Dock Door 7, for PO-2026-00441 (Tyson Foods). Reefer set-point: 34°F. Continuous logger printout shows no excursions during 6-hour transit.

10. **Review Continuous Temperature Log:** Examine the carrier-provided temperature data logger printout. Identify any temperature excursions during

transit. If a transit excursion is detected, annotate the log and proceed per Section 7.8 (Disposition Decision) and Section 7.11 (NCR).

11. Apply Temperature Acceptance Standards: Compare trailer and product temperature readings against the standards defined in Section 8. Apply the following mandatory rejection thresholds:

- **Refrigerated / Perishable Product:** Reject if trailer ambient temperature exceeds **40°F (4.4°C)**;
- **Frozen Product:** Reject if trailer ambient temperature exceeds **5°F (-15°C)** or shows evidence of thaw/refreeze;
- **Dry/Ambient:** No temperature threshold; inspect for heat damage if trailer appears excessively hot.

12. Record All Temperature Findings: Document all temperature readings, data logger results, reefer set-point, and compliance status on DeCA Form 1141-R before opening trailer doors.

7.3 Document Verification

13. Compare BOL to Open PO: The Receiving Clerk shall systematically compare the driver-presented BOL against the open PO retrieved from WMS. The following fields must match exactly:

Example: BOL #TYS-2026-09912 lists PO-2026-00441, Vendor: Tyson Foods Inc., Ship Date: July 31, 2026, Ship-To: DeCA DC-East, 48 cs. Frozen Chicken Breast Item #TF-7742. Clerk verifies all fields match WMS PO-2026-00441 data. Check confirmed.

- PO Number;
- Vendor Name and Vendor Code;
- Ship Date (must not exceed PO delivery window);

- DeCA DC Ship-To Address and Facility Code;
- Item Description and Quantities (by SKU/case count).

14. **Verify COA Requirement:** Check WMS or PO special instructions to determine if a Certificate of Analysis is required for any line item. If required, verify the COA is present, covers the correct lot number(s), and meets specification. If COA is missing for a required item, the affected line item must be placed on hold pending COA receipt.

15. **Affix BOL Stamp:** Once document verification is complete, the Receiving Clerk shall affix the official DeCA BOL receiving stamp on the original BOL and enter the date, time, DC facility code, and Receiving Clerk ID.

16. **Document Discrepancies:** Any discrepancy identified during document verification (e.g., wrong PO number, missing items, incorrect vendor) shall be annotated in writing on the BOL with the Receiving Clerk's initials, noted on DeCA Form 1141-R, and reported to the DC Supervisor before proceeding.

7.4 Quantity Count

17. **Unload and Stage for Count:** Direct dock personnel to unload pallets from the trailer and stage them in the designated inspection area. Maintain separation of product by SKU to facilitate accurate counting.

18. **Perform Full Case Count:** Count the total number of cases per SKU/line item and compare against the BOL and PO expected quantities. Record the count on DeCA Form 1141-R.

19. **Break-Open Case Inspection (Spot Check):** For each SKU received, open a minimum of 10% of cases (or a minimum of 3 cases, whichever is greater) to verify inner pack unit counts against the stated case pack quantity. Document the spot-check case numbers and unit counts found.

20. Weigh Catch-Weight Items: For random-weight or catch-weight items (e.g., fresh meat, cheese), weigh a statistically representative sample on the certified floor scale. Compare to PO contracted weight and document variance.

21. Document Quantity Discrepancies: Any quantity shortage, overage, or unit count discrepancy shall be:

Example: PO-2026-00441 lists 48 cases TF-7742. Physical count yields 46 cases. Receiving Clerk annotates BOL: "SHORTAGE: 2 CS Item #TF-7742 — Received 46 of 48." Driver signs acknowledgment. DeCA Form 1141-R updated accordingly.

- Annotated clearly on the face of the BOL with the specific item, expected quantity, and actual quantity received;
- Recorded on DeCA Form 1141-R under the "Discrepancy" field;
- Acknowledged by the driver via signature on the BOL annotation.

22. Over-shipment Handling: Quantities received in excess of the PO must not be accepted without DC Supervisor authorization. Excess product shall be segregated and tagged pending disposition instruction from the Contracting Officer.

7.5 Physical Inspection

23. Inspect Outer Packaging Integrity: For each pallet and case, examine the outer packaging for the following conditions. Any positive finding must be documented on DeCA Form 1141-R:

- Torn, crushed, punctured, or otherwise compromised cartons or packaging material;
- Evidence of moisture, water staining, or leakage indicating possible temperature excursion or compromised seals;

- Foreign odors (sour, ammonia, rancid, chemical) upon opening cases;
- Abnormal product color or appearance visible through transparent packaging;
- Evidence of pest activity (rodent droppings, gnaw marks, insect infestation, webbing);
- Mold, biological growth, or visible contamination on product or packaging surfaces.

24. Verify USDA/FSIS Inspection Stamps: For all regulated meat, poultry, and egg products, verify that valid USDA/FSIS official inspection stamps are present on primary packaging and/or shipping containers. Absence of required stamps constitutes a mandatory rejection condition.

25. Inspect Pallet Integrity: Verify that pallets are structurally sound, properly stretch-wrapped, and free of foreign material, splinters, or contamination that could compromise product safety.

26. Document and Photograph Defects: Photograph any damage, contamination, or anomaly found using the DC inspection tablet/camera. Attach digital photos to the associated NCR in the DeCA Document Management System (DMS).

7.6 Lot Number and Expiration Date Recording

27. Scan or Manually Record Lot Numbers: Using the WMS handheld scanner, scan the lot number barcode on each case or pallet label. If the barcode is unreadable, manually transcribe the lot number on DeCA Form 1141-R. *Example: Inspector INS-042 scans lot number LOT-TC-8812 on all 46 received cases of Item #TF-7742 (Tyson Frozen Chicken Breast). Lot is confirmed and recorded in WMS under PO-2026-00441 receiving transaction.*

28. Record Expiration Dates: Record the expiration or "Use By" date from each case on DeCA Form 1141-R. For multi-lot shipments, record lot number and expiration date per lot.

29. **Verify Minimum Shelf Life Compliance:** Calculate the percentage of remaining shelf life at the time of receipt using the formula:
- $$\text{Remaining Shelf Life (\%)} = \frac{(\text{Expiration Date} - \text{Receipt Date})}{(\text{Expiration Date} - \text{Manufacture Date})} \times 100$$
- Reject any item with less than 50% remaining shelf life.** Annotate rejection on DeCA Form 1141-R and affix Rejection Tag (DeCA Form 1140-R).
30. **Flag Near-Date Product:** Items with 50–60% remaining shelf life shall be flagged in WMS with a "Near-Date Alert" for expedited pick planning, even if accepted for receipt.
31. **Enter Lot and Expiration Data in WMS:** All lot numbers and expiration dates must be entered into WMS as part of the receiving transaction (see Section 7.9) to enable full lot traceability and FIFO management.

7.7 Temperature Probe Check

32. **Select Probe Check Samples:** The Quality Inspector shall perform internal product temperature checks using the calibrated probe thermometer on a representative sample of temperature-sensitive product. Minimum sampling requirements:
- Fresh/Refrigerated Meat, Poultry, Seafood: minimum 3 probe insertions per lot;
 - Dairy Products: minimum 2 probe insertions per lot;
 - Fresh Produce: minimum 3 locations per pallet;
 - Frozen Product: minimum 3 probe insertions per lot, inserting probe into product mass (not surface).
33. **Insert Probe Correctly:** Insert the probe between two packages or into the product mass (for frozen items, into a pre-drilled guide hole if needed) to obtain the internal/ambient product temperature rather than a surface reading.

34. **Record All Probe Readings:** Document each temperature reading, the product description, lot number, case position on pallet, and time of reading on DeCA Form 1141-R.

35. **Compare to Acceptance Standards:** Compare probe readings against the temperature acceptance standards in Section 8. Any reading outside the acceptance range constitutes a temperature excursion and triggers the rejection procedure in Section 7.8.

36. **Sanitize Probe:** Between each insertion, sanitize the probe tip with food-safe alcohol wipes to prevent cross-contamination between product lots or categories.

7.8 Disposition Decision

Upon completion of all inspection steps (Sections 7.2 through 7.7), the Quality Inspector shall make a disposition determination for each PO line item. The permissible dispositions are defined as follows:

Disposition	Condition	Required Action
ACCEPT	All line items fully conform to PO specifications, temperature standards, quantity requirements, labeling, and physical inspection criteria.	Proceed to WMS entry (Section 7.9) and storage placement (Section 7.12).
ACCEPT — PARTIAL	A portion of the shipment conforms; specific cases, lots, or line items are non-conforming. Conforming portion is accepted; non-conforming portion is rejected.	Accept conforming items into WMS. Affix Rejection Tags (DeCA Form 1140-R) to all non-conforming items. Segregate non-conforming product. Initiate NCR (Section 7.11).
REJECT	The entire shipment or a line item fails one or more inspection criteria (see Section 9 for full rejection criteria list).	Affix Rejection Tags to all non-conforming product. Do NOT enter into WMS inventory. Notify vendor (Section 7.10). Initiate NCR (Section 7.11). Coordinate return with Transportation Coordinator.

37. **Apply Rejection Tags:** For any rejected pallet, case, or unit, the Quality Inspector shall immediately affix a completed DeCA Form 1140-R Rejection Tag. The tag must include: date, time, PO number, lot number, rejection reason code, and Inspector ID. *Example: Inspector INS-042 affixes Rejection Tag (Form 1140-R) to 2 pallets of LOT-TC-8812 after probe check reveals internal product temperature of 52°F, exceeding the 40°F threshold for refrigerated poultry. Rejection Reason Code: R-03 (Temperature Excursion).*
38. **Segregate Non-Conforming Product:** Physically move all rejected product to the designated quarantine zone within the DC. Quarantine zone must be clearly marked and separated from accepted inventory to prevent accidental staging or shipment.
39. **DC Supervisor Review:** For all full-shipment rejections and for Accept-Partial decisions exceeding \$2,000 in value, the DC Supervisor must review the inspector's findings and countersign DeCA Form 1141-R before the disposition is considered final.

7.9 WMS Entry

40. **Open Receiving Transaction in WMS:** The Receiving Clerk shall open a new receiving transaction in WMS, linked to the PO number and BOL number.
41. **Enter Received Quantities by Line Item:** For each accepted or partially accepted line item, enter the received quantity (cases and units as applicable) into WMS. Do not enter quantities for rejected items.
42. **Enter Lot Numbers and Expiration Dates:** For each line item, enter or confirm the lot number(s) and expiration date(s) scanned during Section 7.6. This data is mandatory for lot traceability and recall readiness.
43. **Assign Storage Location:** Enter the designated storage location (aisle, bay, level) for each received SKU in WMS, consistent with FIFO sequencing. The system will prompt the correct putaway location based on existing inventory lot dates.

44. **Record Inspector ID:** Enter the Quality Inspector's ID in the WMS receiving transaction Inspector field. *Example: Receiving Clerk enters WMS transaction for PO-2026-00441: 46 cs. Item #TF-7742, Lot LOT-TC-8812, Exp. 03/15/2027, Location: Freezer Aisle 12, Bay 4, Level 2, Inspector: INS-042. Transaction confirmed and closed.*

45. **Confirm and Close Transaction:** Review all entered data for accuracy, confirm the receiving transaction in WMS, and print the WMS receiving confirmation for attachment to the file copy of DeCA Form 1141-R.

46. **Timeliness Requirement:** WMS entry must be completed within **2 hours of physical receipt** of the shipment. Delays beyond 2 hours must be reported to the DC Supervisor with justification.

7.10 Vendor Notification

47. **Submit Discrepancy Notification:** For any shipment with quantity discrepancies, quality defects, or rejected items, the Receiving Clerk shall submit a formal discrepancy notification to the vendor via the **DeCA Vendor Portal** within **24 hours of receipt**. The notification must include:

- PO Number;
- BOL Number;
- Date and time of receipt;
- DeCA DC Facility Code and location;
- Item number(s) and description of affected product;
- Lot number(s) and expiration date(s);
- Nature and quantity of discrepancy or defect;
- Disposition decision (Reject / Accept-Partial);
- Supporting photos (attached as PDF or JPEG).

48. **Vendor Response Window:** Vendors have **48 hours** from the timestamp of the Vendor Portal notification to acknowledge the discrepancy and propose a

resolution. Failure to respond within 48 hours authorizes DeCA to proceed with chargeback processing per the DeCA Vendor Compliance Manual, Rev. 2026.

49. **Document Notification:** Record the Vendor Portal submission reference number on DeCA Form 1141-R and in the WMS NCR record.

7.11 Non-Conformance Report (NCR)

50. **Initiate NCR:** The Quality Inspector shall initiate an NCR in the DeCA Document Management System (DMS) for every shipment or line item that results in a Reject or Accept-Partial disposition. The NCR must be opened on the same day as the inspection.

51. **NCR Content Requirements:** The NCR must document:

- NCR number (auto-generated by DMS);
- Date and time of NCR initiation;
- Receiving Inspector ID and DC facility;
- PO number, BOL number, vendor name and code;
- Affected item numbers, lot numbers, expiration dates, and quantities;
- Description of non-conformance (specific defect, regulatory violation, or discrepancy);
- Disposition decision and rejection reason code;
- Photos and supporting documentation (attached in DMS).

52. **Escalate to DC Supervisor:** The Quality Inspector shall notify the DC Supervisor verbally and in the DMS NCR workflow within 1 hour of NCR initiation. The DC Supervisor must review and countersign the NCR in DMS within 2 business days.

53. **Chargeback Authorization:** If the NCR supports a vendor chargeback, the DC Supervisor shall initiate chargeback documentation in the DeCA Vendor Portal.

Chargebacks exceeding **\$500** require written authorization from the assigned DeCA Contracting Officer (CO) before submission to the vendor.

54. **NCR Closure:** The NCR is considered closed when: (a) the vendor has acknowledged and resolved the discrepancy or agreed to the chargeback; (b) the DC Supervisor has confirmed resolution in DMS; and (c) any replacement product has been received and inspected per this SOP. Target closure time is **5 business days** (see Section 12, KPIs).

7.12 Storage Placement

55. **Assign FIFO-Compliant Storage Location:** Using WMS-directed putaway, move all accepted product to the designated storage zone and location consistent with FIFO stock rotation. Product with earlier expiration dates must be stored in front of, or accessible before, product with later expiration dates.
56. **Refrigerated/Frozen Product — Time Requirement:** All refrigerated and frozen product must be physically placed into the appropriate temperature-controlled storage zone within **30 minutes of completion of inspection**. This requirement is mandatory and non-negotiable to maintain cold-chain integrity.
57. **Produce Handling:** Fresh produce shall be moved to the produce cooler immediately upon inspection completion. Produce must not be staged in ambient dock areas beyond 15 minutes.
58. **Dry/Ambient Product:** Dry goods shall be palletized, stretch-wrapped, and moved to the designated dry storage location within 4 hours of inspection. No product shall remain on the receiving dock overnight.
59. **Apply Putaway Labels:** Affix WMS-generated putaway labels to each pallet confirming location, PO number, lot number, and receipt date, to support ongoing inventory accuracy and cycle count operations.

60. Confirm Putaway in WMS: The dock associate completing putaway shall scan the storage location barcode and pallet label in WMS to confirm the physical location transaction, closing the putaway task.

8. Temperature Acceptance Standards

The following table establishes mandatory temperature acceptance standards for all product categories received at DeCA Distribution Centers. Product received outside these ranges is subject to mandatory rejection per Section 7.8. Readings shall be taken using calibrated instruments per Section 6 and recorded on DeCA Form 1141-R.

Product Category	Examples	Required Receiving Temp (°F)	Required Receiving Temp (°C)	Action if Exceeded
Frozen	Frozen meat, poultry, seafood, frozen vegetables, ice cream, frozen meals	≤ 5°F; no evidence of thaw/refreeze	≤ -15.0°C	Mandatory Rejection; initiate NCR
Refrigerated Meat, Poultry & Seafood	Fresh chicken, beef, pork, fish, deli meats, vacuum-packed seafood	28°F – 40°F (28°F preferred for raw poultry)	-2.2°C – 4.4°C	Reject if >40°F; partial review if 38–40°F with supervisor concurrence
Dairy Products	Fluid milk, cheese, butter, yogurt, cream, eggs	34°F – 40°F	1.1°C – 4.4°C	Reject if >40°F; inspect for curdling, off-odor
Fresh Produce	Lettuce, tomatoes, berries, apples, citrus, root vegetables	34°F – 55°F (varies by item; see DeCA Produce Spec Sheet)	1.1°C – 12.8°C	Reject if outside range; inspect for decay, wilting, freezing damage
Dry / Ambient	Canned goods, boxed cereals, snacks, condiments,	No refrigeration required; max 85°F ambient	Max 29.4°C	Inspect for heat damage (bulging cans, melted

Product Category	Examples	Required Receiving Temp (°F)	Required Receiving Temp (°C)	Action if Exceeded
	dry pasta, baking goods			product); escalate to supervisor if heat damage evident
Health & Beauty Care (HBC) / General Merchandise	Vitamins, OTC medications, personal care items, household products	Per manufacturer specification; ambient 60–85°F typical	15.6°C – 29.4°C	Consult product spec sheet; reject if manufacturer temp range exceeded

IMPORTANT — THAW/REFREEZE DETECTION

Evidence of thaw/refreeze in frozen product (e.g., ice crystals on product surface inside packaging, pooled liquid at bottom of case, misshapen product) constitutes an automatic rejection condition regardless of current trailer temperature reading.

9. Rejection Criteria

Any inbound shipment or individual line item exhibiting one or more of the following conditions shall be subject to immediate rejection by the Quality Inspector. The DC Supervisor must be notified of any full-load rejection. All rejections must be documented on DeCA Form 1141-R and supported by an NCR per Section 7.11.

- **Temperature Excursion:** Product received at temperatures outside the ranges specified in Section 8, including evidence of thaw/refreeze in frozen items or transit temperature excursion documented on the continuous data logger printout;
- **Damaged or Compromised Packaging:** Cartons that are torn, crushed, soaked, opened, or otherwise breached in a manner that exposes product to potential contamination or deterioration;

- **Pest Evidence:** Any indication of rodent activity (droppings, gnaw marks, nesting material), insect infestation (live or dead insects, webbing, frass), or other biological contamination on product or packaging;
- **Wrong Item Delivered:** Product received that does not match the item number, description, brand, or UPC listed on the purchase order or BOL;
- **Wrong Quantity — Unresolvable Shortage:** Quantity shortages that the vendor and driver cannot resolve or substantiate on-site, resulting in an inability to fulfill minimum PO requirements for critical items;
- **Expired Product:** Any product for which the printed expiration, "Best By," "Use By," or "Sell By" date has passed as of the date of receipt;
- **Near-Expired Product (Below 50% Remaining Shelf Life):** Product that, at the time of receipt, has less than 50% of its total shelf life remaining, calculated from manufacture date to expiration date;
- **Missing USDA/FSIS Official Inspection Stamp:** Any regulated meat, poultry, or egg product lacking the required USDA FSIS official inspection mark on primary packaging or shipping container;
- **Missing or Non-Conforming Certificate of Analysis (COA):** For product categories that require a COA (per WMS PO flags or DeCA Vendor Compliance Manual), failure to provide a valid COA covering the received lot number at time of delivery;
- **Foreign Material / Contamination:** Presence of glass, metal, chemical residue, or any foreign material in or on product packaging;
- **Unauthorized Substitution:** Vendor substitution of a different product, brand, size, or pack configuration not pre-authorized by the DeCA Contracting Officer;
- **Improper Labeling:** Absence of required nutritional labeling, allergen declarations, country of origin labeling (COOL), or FDA-mandated label elements under 21 CFR Part 101.

10. Non-Conformance and Escalation

10.1 Non-Conformance Report (NCR) Process

Upon identification of a non-conforming shipment or line item, the following process shall be followed in sequence:

61. **Identification and Tagging (Day 0):** Quality Inspector identifies non-conformance during inspection, affixes Rejection Tags (DeCA Form 1140-R) to all affected product, and physically segregates product in the quarantine zone.
62. **NCR Initiation (Day 0, within 2 hours of inspection):** Inspector opens NCR in DeCA DMS with all required fields completed (see Section 7.11). Inspector verbally notifies DC Supervisor.
63. **Vendor Notification (Day 0-1, within 24 hours):** Receiving Clerk submits discrepancy notification in DeCA Vendor Portal (see Section 7.10). Portal auto-generates a case number linked to the NCR.
64. **DC Supervisor Review (Day 1-2):** DC Supervisor reviews NCR, confirms findings, and countersigns in DMS. Supervisor authorizes chargeback if applicable and initiates chargeback documentation in Vendor Portal.
65. **Vendor Response and Resolution (Day 2-3):** Vendor acknowledges discrepancy via Vendor Portal within 48 hours. Vendor proposes resolution: replacement shipment, credit memo, or chargeback acceptance.
66. **NCR Closure (by Day 5):** Upon confirmed resolution, DC Supervisor marks NCR as "Resolved" in DMS. If replacement product is received, it undergoes full inspection per this SOP before NCR is closed.

10.2 Vendor Chargeback Authorization

Vendor chargebacks may be assessed for the following non-conformance types: quantity shortages, quality failures, non-compliant product, temperature excursions

attributable to vendor or carrier, and missing documentation. Chargeback rates are defined in the DeCA Vendor Compliance Manual, Rev. 2026.

Chargeback Value	Authorization Required From	Documentation Required
Up to \$499.99	DC Supervisor	Completed NCR, signed DeCA Form 1141-R, Vendor Portal submission
\$500.00 – \$4,999.99	DC Supervisor + DeCA Contracting Officer (CO) written authorization	NCR, DeCA Form 1141-R, Vendor Portal case, Contracting Officer email or memo
\$5,000.00 and above	DC Supervisor + CO + Director, Logistics & Distribution	All above plus formal chargeback justification memo routed through DeCA Contracting

10.3 Escalation Triggers

The DC Supervisor shall escalate to the Director, Logistics & Distribution and DeCA Contracting under the following conditions:

- Vendor chargeback value exceeds \$500 for a single delivery event;
- A single vendor incurs three (3) or more NCRs within a 90-day period;
- A rejection event involves a potential food safety hazard (pathogen risk, foreign material, adulterated product) that may require FDA/USDA notification under FSMA Reportable Food Registry obligations;
- A full-load rejection event where the vendor refuses to accept or acknowledge the discrepancy;
- NCR remains unresolved beyond 5 business days.

FOOD SAFETY ESCALATION — MANDATORY REPORTING

If at any time a Quality Inspector suspects that received product poses an imminent food safety risk (e.g., Listeria, Salmonella contamination signals, foreign objects),

the DC Supervisor and DeCA Food Safety Officer must be notified immediately. Product must be quarantined and must NOT enter commerce until cleared. Mandatory reporting obligations under 21 U.S.C. § 2223 (FSMA Reportable Food Registry) may apply.

11. Records and Retention

All records generated in connection with the receiving and inspection process shall be maintained in accordance with Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) 4.703 and applicable DeCA records management policy. The minimum retention period for all records described in this section is **three (3) years** from the date of the receiving event, unless a longer period is required by specific regulatory mandate or active litigation hold.

Record Type	Description	Retention Period	Storage Location
Bill of Lading (BOL)	Original or copy of the carrier BOL, stamped and annotated by the Receiving Clerk. Includes all discrepancy notations and driver acknowledgment signatures.	3 years minimum (FAR 4.703)	DeCA Document Management System (DMS); DC file room (original)
Receiving Inspection Checklist (DeCA Form 1141-R)	Completed inspection form for each delivery, capturing all temperature readings, quantity counts, lot numbers, expiration dates, inspection findings, and disposition decisions.	3 years minimum	DeCA DMS (scanned PDF); DC inspection records binder (paper original)

Record Type	Description	Retention Period	Storage Location
WMS Receiving Transaction Logs	Electronic records of all WMS receiving transactions, including PO number, quantities entered, lot numbers, storage locations, timestamps, and user IDs.	3 years minimum; 7 years for transactions over \$10,000	DeCA Enterprise WMS database; archived per WMS Administrator schedule
Non-Conformance Reports (NCRs)	All NCRs initiated for rejected or non-conforming product, including all supporting documentation, photos, vendor correspondence, and resolution records.	3 years minimum from NCR closure date	DeCA DMS — NCR module; linked to associated PO and vendor records
Temperature Data Logger Printouts	Carrier-provided continuous temperature records for refrigerated and frozen shipments, reviewed and retained at time of receipt.	3 years minimum	Scanned and attached to DeCA Form 1141-R in DMS
Certificates of Analysis (COA)	Vendor-provided COAs for regulated product categories. Must be retained and linked to the associated PO and lot number.	3 years minimum or as required by applicable product regulation	DeCA DMS — COA repository; linked to lot number in WMS
Rejection Tags (DeCA Form 1140-R)	Copies (photographed) of rejection tags affixed to non-conforming product. Originals accompany rejected product; copies retained in DMS with associated NCR.	3 years minimum	DeCA DMS — attached to NCR record
Vendor Portal	All submitted	3 years minimum	DeCA Vendor Portal

Record Type	Description	Retention Period	Storage Location
Discrepancy Notifications	discrepancy notifications and vendor responses from the DeCA Vendor Portal, including case numbers, submission timestamps, and resolution correspondence.	from notification date	system; exported PDF archived in DMS

RECORDS ACCESS NOTE

All records stored in the DeCA DMS are subject to the Privacy Act and FOIA provisions applicable to FOUO-designated records. Access is limited to personnel with a verified need-to-know. Records shall not be removed from the DMS or DC file room without written authorization from the DC Supervisor.

12. Key Performance Indicators (KPIs)

The following KPIs shall be used to monitor the effectiveness and compliance of the receiving and inspection process at all DeCA Distribution Centers. KPI data shall be compiled monthly by the WMS Administrator and reviewed by the DC Supervisor. Quarterly KPI summaries shall be reported to the Director, Logistics & Distribution.

KPI	Definition	Target	Measurement Method	Reporting Frequency
Receiving Accuracy Rate	Percentage of inbound PO line items received with zero quantity discrepancy relative to the PO and BOL	≥ 99.0%	WMS receiving transaction data vs. PO quantities; NCR discrepancy records	Monthly

KPI	Definition	Target	Measurement Method	Reporting Frequency
	quantities.			
Inspection Cycle Time	Average elapsed time from trailer arrival at the assigned dock door to completion of WMS receiving entry, per delivery.	≤ 45 minutes per delivery	WMS timestamp: arrival check-in vs. transaction close; recorded on DeCA Form 1141-R	Monthly
Temperature Excursion Rate	Percentage of inbound temperature-controlled deliveries in which a temperature excursion (trailer or product) is identified at time of receipt.	≤ 1.0%	NCR records coded with rejection reason R-03 (Temperature Excursion); Form 1141-R temperature logs	Monthly
Vendor Rejection Rate	Percentage of inbound vendor deliveries resulting in a full or partial rejection disposition, expressed as a percentage of total deliveries received in the period.	≤ 2.0%	NCR count / total receiving transactions in WMS; segmented by vendor for root cause analysis	Monthly; vendor-level quarterly
NCR Closure Time	Average number of business days from NCR initiation to confirmed resolution and closure in the DeCA DMS, across all NCRs closed in the period.	≤ 5 business days	DMS NCR module: initiation date vs. closure date; calculated by WMS Administrator	Monthly

KPI	Definition	Target	Measurement Method	Reporting Frequency
WMS Entry Timeliness Rate	Percentage of receiving transactions entered into WMS within 2 hours of physical product receipt.	≥ 98.0%	WMS receipt timestamp vs. physical arrival log; exceptions reported to DC Supervisor	Monthly
Cold-Chain Placement Compliance Rate	Percentage of refrigerated and frozen deliveries placed into temperature-controlled storage within 30 minutes of inspection completion.	100%	WMS putaway timestamp vs. inspection completion timestamp on DeCA Form 1141-R	Monthly

KPI performance falling below target thresholds for two (2) consecutive reporting periods shall trigger a formal Corrective Action Plan (CAP), developed by the DC Supervisor and submitted to the Director, Logistics & Distribution within 10 business days.

13. Training Requirements

All personnel performing functions defined in this SOP are required to successfully complete applicable training prior to independent performance of those functions. Training compliance is the joint responsibility of the individual employee and the DC Supervisor.

13.1 Annual Training Mandate

All Receiving Clerks, Quality Inspectors, dock personnel, and DC Supervisors involved in inbound receiving operations must complete the following training on an **annual basis** (calendar year, January–December). Training completion must be documented in the DeCA Training Management System (TMS):

- **DeCA SOP-01 Receiving & Inspection Annual Refresher** — 4-hour instructor-led or online module covering all sections of this SOP, with scenario-based assessment. Pass score: 80% or higher;
- **DeCA Vendor Compliance Manual Overview** — 2-hour online module covering current-year vendor compliance requirements and chargeback policies;
- **Cold Chain and Temperature Management** — 2-hour module covering proper use of calibrated thermometers, temperature logging, and excursion identification;
- **WMS Inbound Receiving Operations** — 3-hour module covering WMS receiving transaction entry, lot tracking, FIFO putaway, and discrepancy documentation.

13.2 Food Safety Certification

All Quality Inspectors must hold and maintain a current food safety certification from one of the following accredited programs:

- **ServSafe Food Handler Certification** (National Restaurant Association) — or equivalent ANSI/ASTM-accredited food safety certification;
- **HACCP Principles and Application** (International HACCP Alliance-accredited course) — required for Quality Inspectors handling meat, poultry, seafood, and dairy products.

Food safety certifications must be renewed per the certifying body's renewal cycle (typically every 3–5 years). Copies of valid certifications must be on file with the DC Supervisor and in the employee's TMS record. An inspector whose certification has lapsed may not perform Quality Inspector duties until a valid certification is obtained.

13.3 On-the-Job Training (OJT) Checklist Sign-Off

All new personnel assigned to receiving and inspection duties must complete a structured On-the-Job Training (OJT) program before performing independent duties. The OJT program consists of:

- 67. **Orientation Phase (Days 1-3):** Review of this SOP, relevant references, and DC-specific operational procedures under supervision of the DC Supervisor;
- 68. **Supervised Practice Phase (Days 4-14):** Performance of all SOP steps under direct supervision of a qualified, experienced Quality Inspector or Receiving Clerk. Minimum of 10 supervised receiving events required;
- 69. **OJT Checklist Sign-Off:** Completion and signing of the DeCA OJT Competency Checklist (DeCA Form 1150-T) by both the trainee and the supervising employee, countersigned by the DC Supervisor. The checklist covers all 12 procedural steps of Section 7 plus equipment operation and form completion;
- 70. **Competency Assessment:** Passing a practical competency evaluation administered by the DC Supervisor or designee. Pass standard: 90% or higher on all critical-step elements.

TRAINING RECORD REQUIREMENT

Signed OJT checklists, TMS training completion records, and food safety certification copies must be maintained in the employee's personnel training file at the DC for the duration of employment plus 3 years. These records are subject to audit by the DeCA Inspector General and Supply Chain Operations Division.

14. Revision History

The following table documents all revisions to this Standard Operating Procedure. All revisions require review by the Supply Chain Operations Division and approval by the Director, Logistics & Distribution prior to issuance.

Version	Effective Date	Description of Changes	Prepared By	Approved By
1.0	August 1, 2026	Initial Release — Establishes standardized receiving and inspection procedures for all DeCA Distribution Centers. Covers all 14 sections including pre-arrival preparation, temperature verification, document verification, quantity count, physical inspection, lot and expiration tracking, WMS entry, vendor notification, NCR process, storage placement, KPIs, and training requirements.	Supply Chain Operations Division	Director, Logistics & Distribution

Approval Signatures

The undersigned certify that this Standard Operating Procedure has been reviewed for accuracy, completeness, and compliance with applicable DeCA directives and federal regulations, and is hereby approved for implementation effective August 1, 2026.

Role	Signature / Name	Title	Date
Reviewed By	Supply Chain Operations Division	Division Chief, Supply Chain Operations	August 1, 2026
Approved By	Director, Logistics & Distribution	Director, Logistics & Distribution Directorate, DeCA	August 1, 2026

Reviewed By — Supply Chain Operations Division:

Supply Chain Operations Division Chief

Defense Commissary Agency | Supply Chain Operations Division

Approved By — Director, Logistics & Distribution:

Director, Logistics & Distribution

Defense Commissary Agency | Logistics & Distribution Directorate

DEFENSE COMMISSARY AGENCY	DeCA-SC-SOP-01 Rev. 1.0	Effective: August 1, 2026
UNCLASSIFIED // FOR OFFICIAL USE ONLY (FOUO) — Handle per DoD Manual 5200.01		